

Adjustment Challenge Warning Signs

Module 12 — What to Watch For & What to Do

EMOTIONAL / BEHAVIORAL

Warning Sign	Seen?	What to Do
Withdrawal from activities	■	Gently invite to one low-pressure activity
Withdrawal from family contact	■	Increase daily check-ins (calls, SeniorSafe)
Expressions of regret / wanting to 'go home'	■	Validate feelings; don't dismiss or argue
Increased irritability or anger	■	Give space, then engage calmly
Crying or persistent sadness	■	Listen without fixing; validate emotions
Refusing to leave apartment	■	Respect pace but ensure daily social contact

PHYSICAL

Warning Sign	Seen?	What to Do
Changes in eating patterns (loss of appetite)	■	Monitor meals; alert community staff
Changes in sleeping (insomnia or oversleeping)	■	Maintain consistent bedtime routine
Weight loss	■	Alert doctor if >5 lbs in 30 days
Physical symptoms without medical cause	■	Schedule doctor visit to rule out causes
Increased falls or unsteadiness	■	Safety reassessment; consult doctor

COGNITIVE

Warning Sign	Seen?	What to Do
Increased confusion or disorientation	■	Orient with signs, labels, routine
Forgetting where they are	■	Reassure; increase familiar items in view
Difficulty learning new routines	■	Simplify; post written schedule visibly
Memory decline beyond baseline	■	Alert doctor; document changes

CALL A PROFESSIONAL IF: 2+ signs persist for more than 2 weeks, or any single sign is severe.

Doctor: _____ Geriatric Care Manager: _____